be done under the circumstances. What a way to start my innings as the battalion commander, an assignment that has meant the most to me in my life as a soldier.



Enroute from Tezu to Hayuliang – a miraculous escape for us, February 1981.

I became the sixth CO of the battalion, the first to have been commissioned in 9 Maratha LI. I had a single-minded resolve to be one of the best commanding officers of the battalion. I held my first 'Sainik Sammelan' and addressed the troops, and spelt out the key result areas that we had to focus on. The first and foremost task was to improve our operational and administrative efficiency. My emphasis has always been on good man-management and I assured them that they would get a fair deal as far as promotions, leave and postings were concerned. I had literally grown up with the 'paltan'. Some of my junior commissioned and non-commissioned officers had been enlisted as soldiers in 1964, when our battalion was raised. So we knew each other like family.